

Liverpool have secured 38 points from 48 — the kind of form that delivered its last league title in 2019–20, with two games to spare.

The defence did its job, keeping eight clean sheets in 16 away fixtures, but it was Salah's goalscoring form on the road that helped turn impending defeats into draws and draws into victories.

Liverpool's transformation into an efficient counter-attacking side has enabled Salah (**right**) to enjoy his best season in terms of output in a Reds shirt. His 46 goal contributions (28 goals and 18 assists) leave him one shy of the all-time Premier League record.

Liverpool was the second-best counter-attacking side in the league last season, averaging a fast break per game with the fourth-best conversion rate. This year, it has been more clinical on turnovers, ranking first for most counter-attacks (1.8 per game) with the best conversion rate in the division.

Of the 41 goals Liverpool scored away from home, Salah was involved in 27 (16 goals and 11 assists) — the most by any player in a single Premier League season. More than half of his goals and assists came away from Anfield. Winners at Wolves and Southampton, and the equaliser away to Arsenal, helped set the tone for Liverpool early in the title race. Liverpool moved to the top of the table after matchweek five and, apart from a single matchday in week nine, it didn't wobble.

Beyond his coaching philosophy, another key factor that tipped the job in Slot's favour was Feyenoord's impressive injury record under him. During his three years in Rotterdam, player availability stayed above 90%. This season, Liverpool's key players remained fit for most of the campaign.

Last season, 20 injured players combined for 218 games missed, while this season, that figure has dropped to just 96 matches with 15 different injured players.

His attention to detail also extends off the pitch, with initiatives including yoga, hydrotherapy sessions, and allowing players to

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sleep at home before home games instead of in hotels. "People who have more knowledge about this than me tell me that you always sleep better in your own bed than a hotel bed," he explained.

Among the players to have started the most games for the Reds in each position, only five missed a combined 24 games, with Van Dijk, Salah, Mac Allister, Andrew Robertson, Gravenberch and Díaz available for 34 gameweeks.

It has been a near-perfect first season for Slot. However, the disappointment of failing to translate Liverpool's early European dominance into knockout success may still sting — but that would have been sweetened by the news that both skipper Van Dijk and Salah have extended their stays at the club.

Having come in with little expectations, Slot, in his unassuming manner, has now raised the bar by making Liverpool the best team in England. But it's impossible to talk about Slot's success without acknowledging Klopp's legacy at the club. Slot himself was the first

to pay tribute, serenading the German during the title-winning celebrations in front of the Kop.

Just as Klopp (**below**) was credited for making the club's fans believe once again, they now know it is in safe hands with Slot.

**All stats updated
till Matchweek 34.**

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